fn sample_geometric_exp_fast

Michael Shoemate

March 9, 2026

This proof resides in **"contrib"** because it has not completed the vetting process.

Proves soundness of `fn sample_geometric_exp_fast` in `mod.rs` at commit 0be3ab3e6 (outdated[1]). This proof is an adaptation of subsection 5.2 of [CKS20].

Vetting history

- Pull Request #519

1 Hoare Triple

Precondition

$\mathtt{x} \in \mathbb{Q} \wedge \mathtt{x} > 0$

Pseudocode

```
def sample_geometric_exp_fast(x) -> int:
    if x == 0:
        return 0

    s, t = Rational.into_numer_denom(x)

    while True:
        u = Integer.sample_uniform_int_below(t) #
        d = bool.sample_bernoulli_exp(Rational(u, t)) #
        if d:
            break

    v = sample_geometric_exp_slow(1) #
    z = u + t * v
    return z // s
```

Postcondition

For any setting of the input parameter `x` such that the given preconditions hold, `sample_geometric_exp_fast` either returns `Err(e)` due to a lack of system entropy, or `Ok(out)`, where `out` is distributed as $Geometric(1 - exp(-x))$.

[1] See new changes with `git diff 0be3ab3e6..09344a4 rust/src/traits/samplers/cks20/mod.rs`

2 Proof

Assume the preconditions are met.

Lemma 2.1. `sample_geometric_exp_fast` only returns `Err(e)` when there is a lack of system entropy.

Proof. `x` is of type `Rational`, there exists some non-negative integer s and positive integer t such that $x = s/t$. This is why `Rational.into_numer_denom` is infallible. Since t is a positive integer, the preconditions on `SampleUniformIntBelow` are met, `sample_uniform_int_below` can only return an error due to lack of system entropy, and u is a non-negative integer. Similarly, the preconditions on `sample_bernoulli_exp` and `sample_geometric_exp_slow` are met, and their definitions guarantee an error is only returned due to lack of system entropy. The only source of errors is from the invocation of these functions, therefore `sample_geometric_exp_fast` only returns `Err(e)` when there is a lack of system entropy. □

We now establish some lemmas that will be useful in proving the distribution of `out`.

- Let u be a realization of a random variable $U \sim Uniform(0, t)$, supported on $[0, t)$.
- Let d be a realization of a random variable $D \sim Bernoulli(exp(-u/t))$
- Let v be a realization of a random variable $V \sim Geometric(1 - exp(-1))$

Lemma 2.2. [CKS20] Conditioned on $d = \top$, if $z = u + t \cdot v$, then z is a realization of a random variable $Z \sim Geometric(1 - exp(-1/t))$. Equivalently, $P[Z = z|D = \top] = (1 - e^{-1/t})e^{-z/t}$.

Proof. For any z, define $u_z := z \ mod \ t$ and $v_z := \lfloor z/t \rfloor$, so that $z = u_z + t \ v_z$.

$$
\begin{aligned}
P[Z = z|D = \top] &= P[U = u_z, V = v_z|D = \top] && \text{since } z = u_z + t \cdot v_z \\
&= P[U = u_z|D = \top]P[V = v_z] && \text{as } U \text{ and } V \text{ are independent} \\
&= \frac{P[U = u_z]}{P[D = \top]} P[D = \top|U = u_z] \cdot (1 - e^{-1})e^{-v_z} && \text{by Bayes' theorem} \\
&= \frac{1/t}{1/t \sum_{k=0}^{t-1} e^{-k/t}} e^{-u_z/t} \cdot (1 - e^{-1})e^{-v_z} && \text{since } P[D = \top] = \frac{1}{t}\sum_{k=0}^{t-1} e^{-k/t} \\
&= \frac{(1 - e^{-1})}{\sum_{k=0}^{t-1} e^{-k/t}} e^{-(u_z/t+v_z)} \\
&= (1 - e^{-1/t})e^{-(u_z/t+v_z)} \\
&= (1 - e^{-1/t})e^{-z/t} && \text{since } z = u_z + t \cdot v_z
\end{aligned}
$$

□

Lemma 2.3. [CKS20] Fix $p \in (0, 1]$. Let G be a $Geometric(1 - p)$ random variable, and $n \geq 1$ be an integer. Then $\lfloor G/n \rfloor$ is a $Geometric(1 - q)$ random variable with $q = p^n$.

Proof.

$$
\begin{aligned}
P[\lfloor G/n \rfloor = k] &= P[nk < G < (k + 1)n] && \text{any } G \text{ in the interval maps to } k \\
&= \sum_{l=kn}^{(k+1)n-1} (1 - p)p^l \\
&= (1 - p^n)p^{nk} \\
&= (1 - q)q^k
\end{aligned}
$$

□

Theorem 2.4. [CKS20] Given any $s, t \in \mathbb{Z}_+$ and $Z \sim Geometric(1 - exp(-1/t))$, define $Y = \lfloor Z/s \rfloor$. Then $Y \sim Geometric(1 - exp(-s/t))$.

Proof.

$$\begin{aligned} P[Y = y | D = \top] &= P[\lfloor Z/s \rfloor = y | D = \top] \\ &= (1 - p^s)p^{sk} && \text{by 2.3} \\ &= (1 - (e^{-1/t})^s)(e^{-1/t})^{sk} \\ &= (1 - e^{-s/t})(e^{-s/t})^k \end{aligned}$$

□

Lemma 2.5. If the outcome of `sample_geometric_exp_fast` is `Ok(out)`, then `out` is distributed as $Geometric(1 - exp(-x))$.

Proof. As shown in 2.1, the preconditions for `SampleUniformIntBelow` on line 8, `sample_bernoulli_exp` on line 9, and `sample_bernoulli_exp_slow` on line 13 are met. Therefore, `u`, `d` and `v` follow the distributions necessary to apply 2.2. By 2.2, `z` is a realization of $Z \sim Geometric(1 - exp(-1/t)$. Since `z` is a realization of $Z \sim Geometric(1 - exp(-1/t))$, then by 2.4, `out` is distributed as $Geometric(1 - exp(-x))$. □

Proof. 1 holds by 2.1 and 2.5. □

References

[CKS20] Clément L. Canonne, Gautam Kamath, and Thomas Steinke. The discrete gaussian for differential privacy. *CoRR*, abs/2004.00010, 2020.